Chris DeChamplain

Game Designer

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Designer with 15+ years of experience designing gameplay systems, mechanics, and user experiences across multiple disciplines. Combines creative design thinking, artistic expertise, and technical implementation knowledge to deliver engaging, player-centered experiences from concept through release. Adept at working across the full development pipeline, collaborating with cross-functional teams, and translating design vision into polished, functional features.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Game Designer / Artist

Vault of Ages 2026 - Current

- Designed, tested and published third party content under the Daggerheart SRD.
- Created original illustrations for cover art, logos, interior page art and other necessary assets.
- Developed gameplay mechanics to expand on the current game and its features including curses, boons, magic items, and Gamemaster tools.
- Responsible for UX/UI design and art, including flowcharts, style guides, interfaces, icons and other necessary assets.

Team Lead / Game Designer

FrackinUniverse, 2016 - Current

- Created and led development of the most-subscribed mod for Starbound, growing the community to more than 600,000 players.
- Expanded core gameplay through the design and implementation of new narrative content, progression systems, skill trees, research mechanics, survival features, and a multi-tiered crafting ecosystem.
- Managed a distributed team of 10+ contributors, coordinating deliverables, establishing milestones, and maintaining team engagement throughout development.
- Analyzed player feedback, gameplay metrics, and community sentiment to continually improve balance, progression, and overall player experience.
- Designed and implemented gameplay content including environments, characters, objects, and supporting systems using JSON and Lua scripting.
- Produced hundreds of original pixel art assets spanning environments, characters, props, UI elements, and gameplay objects.
- Designed and built large-scale metroidvania-inspired 2D worlds, emphasizing exploration,

progression gating, discovery, and player flow.
- Managed a large and active player community, overseeing quality assurance, issue triage, bug reporting, and content feedback pipelines.

Lead Game Designer

Zugalu Entertainment 2022-2026

- Designed and drove the vision and implementation of gameplay features, mechanics and systems for multiple released projects including Thrive and Hunter's Moon.
- Responsible for UX/UI design and art, including flowcharts, style guides, interfaces, icons and other necessary assets.
- Owned and maintained all essential documentation; LDDs, GDDs, pitch decks and others as-needed. Successful pitches secured more than $1.5 million in project funding from the Canadian Media Fund, and additional funding from publishers.
- Served in a leadership role, mentoring and skill-building where necessary and collaborating with team members to ensure cohesion and meet milestone requirements on-time.
- Championed level design; created blockouts, fine-tuned movement and traversal, and extensively tested and iterated on designs.
- Created any additional art assets necessary for the completion of projects.
- Assisted in scripting and programming, refining systems and mechanics and providing balance and iterative improvements.

Game Designer / Level Designer

Arbelos Interactive 2021-2022

- Created educational game environments from concept to final art, balancing engagement, accessibility, and learning objectives.
- Designed player-centric controls, UX/UI systems, and gameplay interactions for web, mobile, and game experiences.
- Rapidly prototyped game mechanics and systems to support iterative design and product validation.
- Contributed to innovative AR and mobile initiatives, helping bridge emerging technologies with intuitive user experiences.
- Produced and maintained clear design documentation to support cross-disciplinary development and project delivery.

Game Designer / Level Designer

Novaquark 2021-2022

- Created large-scale voxel environments using proprietary development tools, including player hubs, megastructure dungeons, spacecraft, and instanced multiplayer regions.

- Designed and scripted first-time user experiences (FTUE) for crafting, mining, and player-driven economy systems, improving onboarding and feature adoption.
- Prototyped gameplay puzzles, mission scenarios, and new features, producing supporting documentation and implementation specifications.
- Developed environmental storytelling assets including maps, UI elements, signage, advertisements, and lore-driven in-game content.
- Created interactive in-game web pages, databases, economic dashboards, and information systems using HTML, CSS, and digital art.
- Collaborated with design and content teams to create engaging missions and gameplay experiences for live-service multiplayer environments.

Level Designer

Powerlevel Studios 2019

- Designed and mapped over 100 interconnected levels, taking them from paper prototypes through Unity blockouts to final implementation within a metroidvania-style progression framework.
- Created and integrated environmental art assets and tile set additions to support level design requirements and visual consistency.
- Built levels that emphasized exploration, progression gating, player navigation, and meaningful reward structures.

EDUCATION

Game Level Design [Post Grad], Sheridan College 2019

Graduated with Honors

Web Design & Information Technology, Herzing College 2003

Graduated with Honors, Dean's List Award

SKILLS

Technical: 3Cs, Agile Development, C#, CSS, Documentation, GitHub, HTML, JavaScript, JSON, Level Blockouts, Lua, Maya, SASS, Technical Writing, Unity

Creative: Adobe Suite, Affinity, Canva, Creative Writing, Digital Art, Figma, Illustration, Worldbuilding

Professional: Digital Marketing, HacknPlan, Leadership, Microsoft Office, Project Management, Strategy, Team Building, Trello